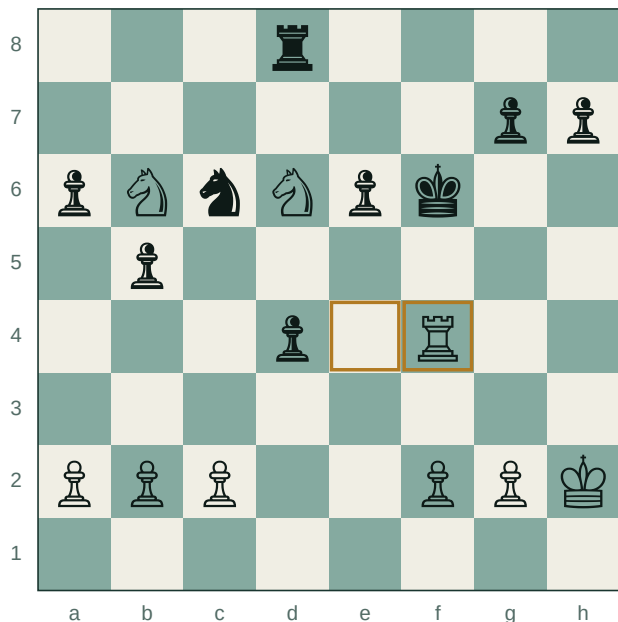


Active defensive resources: Black, move 32

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 32.Rf4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32...Ke5 33. Nf7+ Kxf4 34. Nxd8 Nxd8

32...Ke5 The king moves from f6 to e5. From e5 it attacks rook on f4 and knight on d6. Recorded reply: **33.Nf7+**.

33...Kxf4 The king captures the rook on f4. Recorded reply: **34.Nxd8**.

34...Nxd8 The knight captures the knight on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: knight on d6 and knight on b6. Check for tactical protection.